STEADFAST MEN

Lesson 19 · Lay It Down

Week 19. Lay it down + What she actually needs

Participant worksheet

Steadfast Men
The way of Godly Men
Wes Hart

Read this week: Chapter 23, Lay it down, and Chapter 24, What she actually needs.

One job: Name what you grip hardest, and the sister sentence you are afraid of. Then lay that one thing down daily, and ask her the need she is not getting.

The line

A steadfast man stops waiting, picks up the weight, goes first, and works for God's pay, not the room's.

Write it once.

_____
_____

> **Ephesians 5:25 NIV**
> Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ loved the church and gave himself up for her.

> **Philippians 2:4 NIV**
> not looking to your own interests but each of you to the interests of the others.

Name it

What you grip hardest, full sentence. And the sister sentence you are afraid of.

_____
_____
_____

Do this week

Lay that one thing down every day on purpose without announcing or keeping score.

Ask her plainly what she needs from you that she is not getting, listen to the whole answer, and do the first thing she names before the week is out.

If single: lose a small preference daily, and practice one need from the list on people already in your life.

Grip / ask / first thing named:

_____

_____

Tell a brother

Tell him what you are laying down and how it went, and what she said. Ask him what he sees you holding. Ask whether he has ever asked his wife. Ask each other where you have drifted toward the place that claps.

I told (name): _____ on (day): _____

He will ask: _____

Alone: still tell one man. Same week.

Carry this

Headship is a cross. Men want the authority of Ephesians five without the giving up of Ephesians five. You can be right and lay it down, and that is the whole marriage. She does not need more of what you make. She needs you.

Write it once.

_____

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Leader guide

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Before the room

Read this week: Chapter 23, Lay it down, and Chapter 24, What she actually needs.

Aim: Headship is a cross. You can be right and lay it down. She needs you. One hit on the double.

One job: Name what you grip hardest, and the sister sentence you are afraid of. Then lay that one thing down daily, and ask her the need she is not getting.

Pitfall: Two chapters, one hour, one hit. Do not reprint last week's garden as the whole night. Do not dump the submit verses. Kind: not a strategy to get her back. Singles stay.

Time: about an hour. Church, small group, or a man alone.

A steadfast man stops waiting, picks up the weight, goes first, and works for God's pay, not the room's.

Say it. Do not unpack it. Tonight is the life he kept, then the gift that was still him.

> **Ephesians 5:25 NIV**
> Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ loved the church and gave himself up for her.

> **Philippians 2:4 NIV**
> not looking to your own interests but each of you to the interests of the others.

Open (2-3 min)

Kitchen. Kids down. He had the receipts. He was right. The sentence that would end it was loading. He put the sentence down. Then a different quiet: the week she needed him, he had been building her a life she never asked for.

Say the four. Sit down.

Hit

One hit. Lay it down, then look up.

Gave himself up. Not a speech. Not a move day story. If what he calls leading still leaves him intact, it is not His kind. The assignment is usually the actual life: the last word, the need to be right, the phone in his hand, the evening that belongs to him because he paid for the house. You cannot lay down a life you will not admit you have been keeping.

Then her interests. Not yours in a nicer wrapper. Steadiness. Presence. Safety when he is angry. Words out loud. Lead so she does not carry the whole map. He can ask what she needed and then argue with the answer. Face costs him. If the gift would have landed on him, that is a clue, not a confirmation.

Some of you do not have her in the house. Stay. Practice losing a small preference. Give the actual good of a person who is already named.

Point at both chapters. Then shut up.

Table

Three. Wait.

1. What do you grip hardest, full sentence?
2. What sister sentence are you afraid of?
3. What will you lay down daily, and what will you ask?

Young: you want a war; you get an hour nobody clapped for. Single: the Cross is not a wedding gift; people in reach already have a good that is not yours. Married: she already knows if you kept the life; being right is not the house. Hurt: go slow; not a strategy to get her back. Older: thirty years of the wrong gift is not a tradition. The job going well: you cannot buy the dying.

Run the closer

One grip. One ask. Daily lay down.

Name it. What you grip hardest, full sentence. And the sister sentence you are afraid of.

Do this week. Lay that one thing down every day on purpose without announcing or keeping score. Ask her plainly what she needs from you that she is not getting, listen to the whole answer, and do the first thing she names before the week is out. If single, pick the practice version and lose a small preference daily, and practice one need from the list on people already in your life.

Tell a brother. Tell him what you are laying down and how it went, and what she said. Ask him what he sees you holding. Ask whether he has ever asked his wife. Ask each other where you have drifted toward the place that claps.

Carry this. Headship is a cross. Men want the authority of Ephesians five without the giving up of Ephesians five. You can be right and lay it down, and that is the whole marriage. She does not need more of what you make. She needs you.

If he only hears that he would die for his people, he nods and keeps the life. Get the grip and the ask on the page.

Solo note

Read both chapters. Name the grip. Lay it down daily. Ask the need. Tell one man. You are not finishing a cross by Monday.

Do not open week 20.